

## 6.1 & 6.2 Introduction to Digital Literacy

ڈیجیٹل خواندگی (Digital Literacy) سے مراد ڈیجیٹل آلات، انٹرنیٹ اور آن لائن ٹولز کو محفوظ، مؤثر اور ذمہ دارانہ...

CS XI

Chapter 6: Digital Literacy

Lecture 01 of 14

## 6.1 & 6.2 Introduction to Digital Literacy

### LEARN IT

**Digital literacy** is the ability to understand and use digital devices, the internet, and online tools in a **safe**, **effective**, and **responsible** manner.

Look at the three key words:

- **Safe** – you protect yourself and others online (for example, you do not share passwords or private details).
- **Effective** – you get the job done well (for example, you find the right information quickly).
- **Responsible** – you use information honestly and fairly (for example, you do not copy someone else's work or spread false news).

In our increasingly digital world, digital literacy is essential for **everyone**, not only for computer experts. It enables you to:

- **find** information,
- **communicate** with others,
- **produce** digital content, and
- **solve problems** through technology.

**Did you know?** Digital literacy is not only *using devices*; it is *using digital information safely and wisely*. A digitally literate student can:

Locate information → Organise it properly → Turn it into something useful → Share it responsibly

### WORKED EXAMPLE

#### Is this student digitally literate?

Ali can type fast and plays games on his phone all day. When his teacher asks him to find the population of Karachi, he copies the first number he sees on a random website and does not check where it came from.

**Step 1 – Can he use devices?** Yes. He has basic skills.

**Step 2 – Can he locate and judge information?** No. He did not check whether the website was reliable.

**Step 3 – Conclusion:** Ali has *computer skills* but is not yet fully *digitally literate*. A digitally literate student would compare two or three trusted sources (for example, the Pakistan Bureau of Statistics website) before using the number.

### REMEMBER IT

Remember the four verbs of a digitally literate student: **Locate – Organise – Create – Share** ("LOCS": think of a *lock* that keeps your digital life safe).

### COMMON MISTAKE

**Mistake:** "Digital literacy means knowing how to use a computer." **Fix:** Using a computer is only the start. Digital literacy also means finding, judging, creating and sharing information safely and responsibly.

### اردو میں سمجھیں

ڈیجیٹل خواندگی (Digital Literacy) سے مراد ڈیجیٹل آلات، انٹرنیٹ اور آن لائن ٹولز کو محفوظ، مؤثر اور ذمہ دارانہ طریقے سے سمجھنا اور استعمال کرنا ہے۔ ایک ڈیجیٹل خواندہ طالب علم معلومات تلاش کر سکتا ہے، انہیں ترتیب دے سکتا ہے، ان سے کوئی مفید چیز بنا سکتا ہے اور انہیں ذمہ داری سے دوسروں تک پہنچا سکتا ہے۔

### CHECK YOURSELF

1. Write the definition of digital literacy in one sentence.
2. Name the four things digital literacy enables you to do.

Answers: 1. The ability to understand and use digital devices, the internet and online tools in a safe, effective and responsible manner. 2. Find information, communicate, produce digital content, and solve problems through technology.

### LEARN IT

The **Information Age** is the period we live in now, where vast amounts of data are **produced**, **shared** and **accessed instantly** through the internet, mobile devices and digital platforms (websites, apps, social media).

Simply **having access** to technology is **not enough**. Owning a smartphone does not make you good at using information. You must develop the skills to **understand**, **manage** and **use** information wisely.

Digital literacy goes beyond basic computer skills. It involves three kinds of ability:

| Ability              | What it means                                       | Example                                                     |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Technical            | Knowing how to operate devices and software.        | Creating a Google Form; using a spreadsheet.                |
| Cognitive (thinking) | Thinking critically about information.              | Checking whether a news story is true before believing it.  |
| Social               | Communicating and behaving well with others online. | Being polite in a class WhatsApp group; respecting privacy. |

Together these abilities help you function successfully in a **digital society**.

### WORKED EXAMPLE

**Applying the three abilities.** A video claims "Drinking hot water cures dengue." What does a digitally literate student do?

**Technical:** Uses a search engine to search dengue treatment site:.gov .

**Cognitive:** Notices the video has no doctor or source, and that official health websites do not support the claim. Concludes it is false.

**Social:** Does not forward the video, and politely tells the family group that it is not reliable.

#### REMEMBER IT

Three abilities = "**Tech, Think, Talk**": Technical, Cognitive (think), Social (talk with others).

#### COMMON MISTAKE

**Mistake:** Thinking that "more information" automatically means "better information". **Fix:** In the Information Age the problem is not finding *some* information; it is choosing the *right, reliable* information from too much.

#### اردو میں سمجھیں

معلوماتی دور (Information Age) میں انٹرنیٹ اور موبائل کے ذریعے بے پناہ معلومات فوراً تیار اور شیئر ہوتی ہیں۔ صرف ٹیکنالوجی تک رسائی کافی نہیں؛ معلومات کو سمجھنے، سنبھالنے اور دانشمندی سے استعمال کرنے کی مہارت ضروری ہے۔ ڈیجیٹل خواندگی میں تکنیکی، ذہنی (Cognitive) اور سماجی صلاحیتیں شامل ہیں۔

#### CHECK YOURSELF

1. What is the Information Age?
2. Name the three types of ability that digital literacy involves.

Answers: 1. A period in which vast amounts of data are produced, shared and accessed instantly through the internet, mobile devices and digital platforms. 2. Technical, cognitive and social abilities.

## Extra board practice

These MCQs and questions are extra to the textbook. Close the notes, attempt them, then open the key.

### MCQ 1. Digital literacy is:

- a. Using digital tools safely and smartly
- b. Owning a phone only
- c. Typing 10 words
- d. Watching any video

### MCQ 2. It includes:

- a. Search, evaluate, create, behave ethically
- b. Only cabling
- c. Only NAND
- d. Only sprints

### MCQ 3. A digitally literate student can:

- a. Tell a reliable source from a forward
- b. Believe every screenshot
- c. Post passwords
- d. Skip citations

### MCQ 4. Information age means:

- a. Value of data/knowledge is huge
- b. Stone tools
- c. No networks
- d. No computers

### MCQ 5. Safety in DL includes:

- a. Passwords, privacy, respectful posts
- b. Sharing OTPs
- c. Unknown USBs always
- d. Public exam photos of others without consent

### MCQ 6. This chapter later asks you to:

- a. Collect and present data yourself
- b. Build CPUs
- c. Lay fibre
- d. Write OSI sniffers

## Extra short questions

1. Define digital literacy.
2. Three skills besides “knowing Word”.
3. One unsafe practice.
4. Why it is in a CS course, not only Islamiyat/civics.

## Extra long question

1. A cousin forwards a “BIEK result leaked” screenshot. Using digital literacy, write the steps you take before sharing, and how you would present your finding.

## Extra answer key

**MCQs:** 1. A 2. A 3. A 4. A 5. A 6. A

### Short

1. Ability to find, evaluate, use, create and share digital information safely.
2. Search operators, source judging, privacy, creating a chart, citing.
3. Using the same password for email and JazzCash.
4. You produce and analyse data — you are responsible for it.

### Long

1. Check official site/date/URL, reverse-image, look for primary source. Do not share. Present as a short report: claim, checks, conclusion. Link to later inquiry project.